European Commission

Partnership Evaluation Report: **Sustainable Blue Economy Partnership (SBEP)**

Horizon Europe and the Green Transition
Interim evaluation support study

Independent Expert Report

Research and Innovation

Partnership Evaluation Report: Sustainable Blue Economy Partnership (SBEP)

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Partnership Evaluation Report: Sustainable Blue Economy Partnership (SBEP)

Horizon Europe and the Green Transition
Interim evaluation support study

edited by Katharina Schiller (Fraunhofer Institute for Systems and Innovation Research ISI)

2024 Directorate-General for Research and Innovation EN

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Key definitions, acronyms and glossary

AC	Associated Countries
CETP	Clean Energy Transition Partnership
EC	European Commission
EOOS	European Ocean Observing System
ERA	European Research Area
ERANET	European Research Area Network
EU	European Union
FP	Framework Programme
H2020	Horizon 2020
JPI	Joint Programming Initiative
MS	Member States
R&I	Research and Innovation
SBEP	Sustainable Blue Economy Partnership
SDG	Sustainable Development Goal
SRIA	Strategic Research & Innovation Agenda
ZEWT	Zero Emission Waterborne Transport Partnership

1. Introduction

1.1. Purpose and Scope

This report on the Sustainable Blue Economy Partnership (SBEP) forms part of the ex-post evaluation of H2020 and the interim evaluation of Horizon Europe activities relating to a Green Transition. European Partnerships bring the European Commission and private and/or public partners together to address some of Europe's most pressing challenges through concerted research and innovation initiatives. They are a key implementation tool of Horizon Europe and contribute significantly to achieving the EU's political priorities[1]. Co-Funded Partnerships involve EU Member States and Associated Countries, with research funders and other public authorities at the core of the consortium. The Partnership is based on a grant agreement between the Commission and the consortium of partners, resulting from a call for proposals for a programme co-fund action in a work programme of Horizon Europe.

The purpose of this evaluation report is to provide an assessment of the Co-Funded European Partnership Sustainable Blue Economy Partnership against the evaluation criteria relevance, coherence, efficiency, effectiveness, EU added value, additionality, directionality, international positioning and transparency and openness of the implementation of the Partnership in relation to the Horizon 2020 and Horizon Europe objectives targeting a Green Transition. The SBEP builds on previous work in Horizon 2020, namely the Joint Programming Initiative Healthy and Productive Seas and Oceans (JPI Oceans) and several Horizon 2020 ERA-NET Cofunds. JPI Oceans was created in 2011 as a coordinating and strategic platform that brought together stakeholders from 21 Member States. It aimed to develop a common, integrated approach to marine and maritime research and technology development in Europe.

1.2. Methodology

The partnership progress evaluation report follows the principles of a case study analysis and comprises a mixed-method approach of both quantitative and qualitative data analysis. The data collection process for the partnership evaluation comprised two phases, incorporating information from both H2020 and the initial phase of the partnerships in Horizon Europe. The primary data collection was concluded by July 2023. Supplementary data from the forthcoming Biannual Monitoring Report 2024 was incorporated in December 2023. Due to the short runtime of the Horizon Europe Partnerships, it is noteworthy to bear in mind that many of the partnerships' activities are still ongoing and have not yet been fully accomplished.

As the SBEP is such a young partnership (the Partnership started on 1st September 2022, and the SRIA was decided upon in February 2021), the quantitative data analysis comprises an overview of funding data. As the first SBEP Call was launched on February 13, 2023, an analysis of the project portfolio of the Partnership based upon eCorda is not yet possible.

The qualitative analysis comprises desk research activities and text analysis of the partnership strategic documents and information material from the Partnership's website, as well as material related to the monitoring and progress of the Partnership, as far as it is available. Due to the fact that the Partnership began its activities recently, no material related to prior

[1] https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/funding/funding-opportunities/funding-programmes-and-open-calls/horizon-europe/european-partnerships-horizon-europe_en

evaluations of the Partnership is available, and material on its progress and monitoring is limited. Hence, this initial evaluation cannot draw conclusions about two of the evaluation criteria, namely efficiency and effectiveness, and can only draw first conclusions for the other criteria.

In addition to the desktop research activities, five expert interviews were conducted. These interviews targeted representatives of the Partnership's management, funding agencies, as well as representatives from the European Commission. The goal of the interviews was to gain additional insights and validate the findings of the analysis. The interviews followed a semi-structured, exploratory approach based on guidelines referencing the Partnership report objective.

2. Background of SBEP

The SBEP is a co-funded European Partnership. As a co-funded partnership, it involves EU countries, with research funders and other public authorities at the core of the consortium, based around the bodies of water that surround Europe (Figure Annex 1).

The SBEP is considered the 'blue arm of the Green Deal'. It seeks to engage stakeholders across ocean industry sectors, policy, scientific disciplines, and civil society. It aims where relevant to create synergies with the Mission 'Restore our Ocean and Waters' in order to protect the health of ocean and water systems and thereby secure the health, well-being and prosperity of Europe's citizens.

The SBEP was initially outlined in late 2019/early 2020. It builds on the ERA legacy, including previous work done and networks created through, e.g. relevant Horizon 2020 ERANET Co-funds and JPI Oceans. In terms of strategy, its SRIA builds on the priority of the MS/AC, the EC and the European sea-basin Blue Economy R&I initiatives, an aspect that strongly characterises its overall approach of valuing sea-basin specificities and green digital globally competitive opportunities in a pan-European framework. The Partnership proposal has been online on the EC website since July 2020. The first draft of the Partnership's Strategic Research and Innovation Agenda (SRIA), which outlines the strategic scope of the Partnership's activities, was subject to public consultation from 24 November - 16 December 2020; a total of 212 responses were received, with a large majority coming from Romania.[2] The Partnership's SRIA was finalised and published in February 2021.[3] The Partnership description (including expected impacts) was included in the co-fund Call of the Horizon Europe Work Programme 2021-2022.

The SBEP is co-funded by the European Union through the Horizon Europe research and innovation framework programme and industry funding. €490 million are planned to be invested in the upcoming 7 years. The funding streams are:

- Horizon Europe commitments: €150 million
- Partner commitments: so far € 340.72 million from 60 partner institutions in 25 countries

[2] https://www.jpi-oceans.eu/sites/jpi-oceans.eu/files/managed/Publications%20files/Report%20results%20online%20consultation%2026.01.2020.pdf
[3] https://bluepartnership.eu/sites/bluepartnership-v1.eu/files/documents/2023-06/Sustainable%20Blue%20Economy%20Partnership%20draft%20SRIA_V1.0.1.pdf

2.1. Governance of SBEP

SBEP comprises 60 partner institutions (public and private) from 25 countries across Europe (Figure Annex 2 + Figure Annex 3).

The SBEP is coordinated by Italy through the Ministry of University and Research, with Norway as co-ordinator through the Research Council of Norway. Within the governance structures, including the Executive Committee (composed of all Work Package leaders and co-leaders) and the General Assembly (i.e. the decision-making body of the Partnership), the majority of people were women (as of November 2023). In addition, given the importance of the Green Deal and the digital transformation in the blue sector, a Steering Committee is in place to connect to the policy dimension and to provide advice. As an informal, complementary structure, five basin nodes coordinate activities in their respective areas (Figure Annex 4).

2.2. Intervention Logic

The SBEP aims to design, steer and support a just and inclusive transition to a regenerative, resilient and sustainable Blue Economy, boosting the transformation needed towards a climate-neutral, sustainable, productive and competitive EU by 2030. The SBEP will deliver solutions to strengthen EU and international science-policy interfaces in marine- and maritime-related domains of the EU Green Deal and Digital Europe strategies through aligning national, regional and EU R&I priorities, bringing together science, industry, policy and society. It will also contribute to accelerating the post-pandemic recovery and resilience. In line with the EC's new approach for a sustainable Blue Economy in the EU, the SBEP rolls out impact pathways to catalyse the transformation of ocean economy value chains, deliver ocean knowledge and impact-driven R&I and digital solutions, cooperate to comply with international, EU and national regulations, recommendations and policy strategies; contribute to the social and digital transition by developing innovative governance frameworks that benefit coastal communities, including by reinforcing skills and enhance ocean observation capacity contributing to European Ocean Observing System (EOOS, Figure Annex 5).

Since the starting of SBEP in Q3 of 2022 and its official kick-off in Q1 of 2023, the following activities have taken place until June 2023 (when the data collection for this evaluation study was concluded): the publicly and widely communicated launch of the first transnational Call and its info webinar in the beginning of 2023. Further, evaluation results of the first Call were expected for the end of 2023, as well as the organisation of four strategic workshops to update the SRIA and the signature of the joint declaration with the Zero Emission Waterborne Transport Partnership. Important milestones reached before the kick-off include the setting and revising of the impact-oriented thematic Intervention Areas through a group of experts appointed by countries and named ‘Survey Group’, which will be the basis for SBEP joint calls and other joint activities.

2.3. Thematic Structure of R&I Activities

The SBEP lays an important emphasis on the establishment of strategic partnerships to facilitate joint efforts towards the thematic priorities of the SRIA of the first phase and joint Call of the SBEP: 1. Digital twin of the ocean at sub-sea-basin scale; 2. Blue generation marine structures; 3. Planning and managing sea uses; 4. Healthy 'blue food' under a 'One Health' approach; 5. Enabling the green transition of 'blue food' production.[4] The portfolio of implementation will be based on Joint calls for challenge-driven R&I; it is envisioned to have six

[4] After the closure of data collection of this study, thematic priorities 4 and 5 have been merged for the second call in the course of an annual review process.

calls over the coming seven years[5] as one of the main core elements, combined with a variety of additional activities, including some that still need to be defined in the next phases of the Partnership.

The SBEP's expected impacts address Horizon Europe's intervention area, 'Seas and Oceans', which falls under the second pillar, 'Global challenges and industrial competitiveness'. More specifically, it aims to contribute to the Clusters 'Food and natural resources' as well as 'Climate, Energy and Mobility'. It particularly aims to create synergies with the EU Mission to 'Restore our Ocean and Waters' (Mission Ocean and Waters). For example, the Mission is developing a 'European digital twin of the Ocean'. The SBEP and the Mission will work hand-in-hand to develop the digital twin.

2.4. Project Portfolios

Since the first Joint call was launched in early 2023 and the evaluation of the project applications was expected to be finished at the end of 2023, the analysis of the first 19 R&I projects could not become part of this study, as the data collection was closed in June 2023. Towards the preparation of the first joint Call, several key issues have been decided upon, including the setting of Intervention Areas which will be the basis for SBEP and the Partnership's joint activities in its first phase.

2.5. Other activities

Additional activities offered by SBEP aim to complement its Mission and provide opportunities for individuals, organisations, and businesses to get involved and create a lasting positive impact on oceans and coastal communities. Designed over the first year, including through a technical workshop, the following additional activities with EU-added value have been planned for implementation in the 2nd cycle of the Partnership: alignment of thematic annual programming, alignment of monitoring programmes, sharing of Research Infrastructures. Additional activities are defined as those that will imply contribution from MS/AC different from in cash.

In addition to the joint calls and planned additional activities, the Partnership planned to implement structuring activities to reinforce the ERA further. Among those are co-designing the SRIA or liaising with different organisations at the regional (sea-basin), EU and global levels. Three more structuring activities are described in the following paragraphs.

Ocean literacy' will add a complementary perspective to environmentally driven ocean literacy efforts by promoting the changes in behaviours and attitudes needed to enable the just and sustainable transformation of Europe's Blue Economy. This can generate interest in Europe in sustainable maritime innovations, career options, investment opportunities, and generally, the quest of reconciling economic development with marine ecological integrity. Industry actors will be targeted to help embed the corporate environmental responsibility needed to affect the transition. The thematic foci will be guided by the Intervention Areas and align with the EU4Ocean Coalition. The Partnership will also offer webinars about ocean literacy and communication science and provide an ocean literacy toolkit to enable partnership

[5] https://researchitaly.mur.gov.it/en/2023/02/06/sustainable-blue-economy-mur-led-european-partnership-launched-in-rome/

beneficiaries to improve public knowledge and appreciation of their work and the opportunities in the Blue Economy domain.

Another planned structuring activity is the 'Exploitation and Impact Network'. The network aims to develop tools and actions to transfer new knowledge and increase the impact of the co-funded R&I projects at local, regional, national and European levels while taking into account different target groups: policymakers, civil society and the marine and maritime industry. Ultimately, the Exploitation and Impact Network will contribute to enhanced co-creation and knowledge transfer between research, industry, policymakers, and citizens. It does so by using several methods. First, it makes impact pathways mandatory at the project level. Second, it develops an Open Access strategy and addresses Intellectual Property Rights. Third, by increasing the capacities of applicants to the calls, it aims to increase the impact on the target groups' needs. Fourth, it promotes innovative solutions and accelerates their market uptake. Finally, it bridges science-policy gaps to maximise impact.

Furthermore, a structuring action named “portfolio of projects” will address the clustering of relevant (at thematic or geographical area level) projects supported through different calls under Horizon Europe (including the Mission and other EU Partnerships) or even different funding programmes.

3. Findings

3.1. Relevance

Oceans provide humans with natural resources, host wildlife, keep the climate stable and bear potential for employment opportunities. Moreover, the EU's blue economy is fundamental to the efforts of the European Green Deal and the Recovery Plan for Europe. However, the marine environment is subject to multiple pressures and impacts from human activities, such as fishing, seabed disturbance, pollution and global warming. In its 'new approach for a sustainable Blue Economy in the EU'[6], the EC caters to these challenges in order to future-proof the European Blue Economy. The SBEP addresses several SDGs, most prominently SDG 6, 'Clean water and sanitation' and SDG 14, 'Life below water'. It further contributes to SDGs 3, 'Good health and well-being' and SDG 13, 'Climate action'. It incrementally contributes to SDG 7, 'Affordable and clean energy', SDG 8, 'Decent work and economic growth', SDG 9, 'Industry, innovation and infrastructure', SDG 12, 'Responsible consumption and production' and SDG 17 Partnerships for the Goals.

The SBEP boosts the transformation towards a climate-neutral, sustainable, productive and competitive Blue Economy. Moreover, it aims to restore the ocean's health, resilience and services to people by enabling economic activity that is climate-neutral, sustainable and productive. Its relevance with respect to a Green Transition can, therefore, be seen as high. Nonetheless, as the SBEP brings together an array of different stakeholders and topics, respectively, selecting the most promising priority areas for the first Joint Call proved challenging. As interviews showed, the results of the consultations held prior to the first Call may not have fully met all the expectations of particularly regional stakeholders. Yet, going forward in the SBEP's methodology, procedural development, continued consultation and prioritisation processes through survey groups and co-creation workshops are expected to ensure that

[6] https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/PDF/?uri=CELEX:52021DC0240

thematic impact-oriented intervention areas are further enhanced and extended. At the end of 2023 it has already been decided to add an additional intervention area on “Resilience of coastal communities and businesses” for the third joint Call for 2025.

A different issue that stakeholders identified is that the science-policy interface set-up requires further improvement in order to facilitate the communication of results from the SBEP to policymakers. This would increase the relevance of the SBEP's future activities.

3.2. Coherence

It is difficult to assess the internal coherence of SBEP call activities and project portfolios given the point in time of this study, which only could look at the first half year of activities, when the first call was launched. With such a large partnership involving so many countries and different partners, it is difficult to reach coherence among different needs and goals. However, the prioritisation process has been and will continue to be very important in creating coherence and also in developing additional EU benefits. An issue in developing greater internal coherence is creating greater synergies between in-cash and in-kind (i.e., mobilisation of infrastructures) contributions, provided that transparency, inclusivity and fair play are respected. The internal administration of Member States sometimes makes it difficult to address the broad topics covered by the SBEP - for example, in Norway, 11 ministries work with SBEP topics. Another in-country difficulty is that some Member States have multiple funding organisations, which makes it difficult to synergise national funding streams. To overcome these difficulties, several countries have established national mirror mechanisms as best practices and potential examples for others as well.

Coherence with previous work of Horizon 2020 ERA-NETs and from JPIs, including JPI Oceans and JPI Climate, is high. Furthermore, many relationships that were begun in projects during JPI Oceans have often been translated into work in the SBEP, whose strategy and actions are, to a bigger extent, co-designed with the European Commission in comparison to JPI Oceans. The SBEP's activities strongly build on projects and results generated from JPI Ocean's work. Several people being involved in high-level JPI Oceans’ positions, as well as in SBEP, could increase the leverage effect for the impact of SBEP’s research and innovation results. The SBEP also follows up on relevant previous work of sea-basin R&I initiatives.

The SBEP's external coherence is particularly good with several other partnerships, including Biodiversity, Water4All, Zero Emission, and Waterborne Transport. The SBEP and Waterborne Transport announced enhanced cooperation on Sept. 26, 2023 – the first one ever announced between two partnerships. Important connections exist with other initiatives, e.g., Clean Energy Transition. However, it is difficult to remain up-to-date regarding activities undertaken in the numerous other partnerships: in line with this, more structured dialogues and interactions are needed. From an administrative point of view, it has been difficult to create synergies with other initiatives (for example, joint calls with other partnerships are not possible due to EU funding rules to avoid the risk of double funding).

Coherence with several Clusters and Destinations of Horizon Europe’s Pillar II and the Mission Ocean and Waters is also high. However, details remain to be ironed out: A negative point mentioned in the interviews in the summer of 2023 was that the complementarity and synergies between activities in the EC and those in the Partnership, e.g., concerning the digital twin of the ocean, need much more clarification to raise awareness, correct perception and proposals of added value from the community. Meanwhile, the enriching complementarity between the SBEP projects on regional sub-basin Digital Twins of the Ocean versus the Mission Ocean and Waters’ projects has clearly materialised, the SBEP DTO projects being incorporated in the Mission portfolio and participating in the Mission Forum 2024.

Relevant destinations in Cluster 6, 'Food, bioeconomy, natural resources, agriculture and environment' have been taken into account in the SBEP's work, but it remains difficult for the involved stakeholders and call applicants to have an overview of all the ongoing activities and how they link together. This leads to missed opportunities in synergising activities between SBEP and other parts of the Horizon Europe Work Programme. With the first portfolio of SBEP projects set to begin in the first quarter of 2024, it would be important to create a framework for interaction and knowledge exchange between SBEP and Cluster 6 activities. This is also the case for relevant destinations in Cluster 5, 'Climate, energy and mobility'.

3.3. Efficiency

Since the SBEP is in its early stages, no evaluation of its efficiency can be made thus far. From September 2022 (retroactive starting date) to February 2023, a joint call on 5 thematic areas was launched, for €50 million (public info). 94 proposals were received, of which 91 were eligible (internal info), and 19 projects were finally selected for funding at the end of the year 2023.

3.4. Effectiveness

Since the SBEP is just beginning, no evaluation of its effectiveness can be made thus far.

3.5. EU added value

The change from a sea-basin focus (in the Horizon 2020 Work Programme) to an EU-wide focus is seen as positive by the involved stakeholders and should bring more added value to the EU in the future. Bringing the Member States together to discuss and define common priorities is seen as very helpful, as are their financial commitments over the 7-year period, which will bring stability for several years. The planned creation of a European-wide community of practice concerning the Sustainable Blue Economy likewise brings added value to the EU and will serve to transfer lessons learned and best practices from one sea basin to another. The SBEP contributes to the Mission 'Restore our Oceans and Waters', for example, to its topic of 'ocean digital twins at sub-sea-basin scale'.

However, even though the SBEP has taken measures to avoid free-rider risks, some of the involved Member States still need to solve their co-funding requirements in order to be able to count on some EU contribution.

3.6. Additionality

Since the SBEP is just beginning, little evaluation of its additionality can be made thus far. One point mentioned was the integration of private-sector companies into the SBEP. Here, the SBEP could prepare the ground for later market uptake of innovations. The SBEP is currently in contact with the European Investment Bank concerning this. Upstream and downstream innovation and financing opportunities exist as well.

3.7. Directionality

Some involved stakeholders feel that the SBEP is ‘trying to do too much at once’. The five priority areas of the first Joint Call may not meet all expectations of stakeholders on directionality yet. Yet, given the breadth of participating stakeholders and of addressed topics respectively, it remains to be seen whether this is just a temporary effect which will pass as the Partnership matures and extends its intervention areas through the yearly revision cycles.

3.8. International positioning and visibility

Oceans do not follow country boundaries, so internationalisation is seen as very important for the SBEP. The SBEP aims to strengthen the EU's positioning and increase its visibility as a top global player in the Sustainable Blue Economy, but no fully elaborated plans exist yet on how to achieve this. A roadmap for international cooperation is currently already available, co-created between SBEP and EC and further discussed within SBEP for follow-up. It gives priority to the European sea basin and the Atlantic Ocean. One international partner (Brazil) has already joined the first transnational Call. Cooperation in more competitive arenas (e.g., competition with China, India, and the US) will be addressed as the SBEP continues.

3.9. Transparency & Openness

The stakeholder consultations to establish the SRIA were considered by stakeholders to be open and transparent. However, the way the SRIA was eventually translated into the first Joint Call intervention areas has been challenged more by interviewed stakeholders, in particular regional ones. It has to be acknowledged that external events can influence such translation processes thus, major changes in priorities or narratives require good communication and feedback to participating stakeholders. The group of experts, the “Survey group”, mandated by the member countries, and national mirror mechanisms put in place in member countries serve this scope of an improved participatory process. The SBEP is very open to all interested stakeholders who would like to participate (including private sector companies).

3.10. Phasing out preparedness

It is not foreseen that the SBEP will continue on its own after EU funding ends. At the time of writing this report, a phasing-out strategy does not exist as being too early. However, preparatory measures are on the way to support the development of this plan in alignment with developments in the Partnership Knowledge Hub.

4. Conclusions: Lessons Learned & Recommendations

The first conclusions sketched here are based on the processes of creating the SBEP and its first 16 months of work (September 2022 – December 2023).

Previous cooperation at the sea-basin level was key to creating the SBEP network. Bringing these different sea-basin networks into one Partnership forced the partners to think beyond their sea basins, in a pan-European dimension but also maintain the regional dimension and relevance by engaging two sea basin contact nodes in each basin. This has been very important in forming the SBEP and is seen as a positive continuation of the previous work by the involved stakeholders. It allows the SBEP to build on relationships created and activities enacted in the framework of other relevant ERA initiatives, including Horizon 2020 Coordination and Support Actions, ERANET Cofunds and the JPI Oceans, among others.

Managing big topics such as 'ocean and seas' involves many ministries and stakeholders at the member state level, which is needed given the complexity of the sectoral and cross-sectoral challenges but requires coordination at the national level and exchange across countries on how to manage efficiency. The Steering Committee, together with national mirror mechanisms put in place in some countries, are a powerful tool in this regard. An issue in developing greater internal coherence is creating more synergy between in-cash contributions and in-kind activities, through a wider variety of in-kind activities that add value to the so far provided and planned in-cash support to the targeted scientific community (i.e. recent ongoing

developments on aligning national research as well as monitoring programmes, sharing research infrastructures and generate portfolios of projects to obtain more integration, efficiency and synergies in uptake of results). Strengthening the connectivity with policy and translating scientific results into actionable advice for societal stakeholders, are areas in which the SBEP could still gradually evolve and envisage to achieve important milestones as part of relevant tasks of the Impact Network and as soon as the first set of co-funded projects will deliver preliminary results. This is being partly addressed by the planned creation of a European-wide community of practice concerning the Sustainable Blue Economy, which will serve to transfer lessons learned and best practices from one sea basin to another.

Because the SBEP's focus is to add value in a multidisciplinary and cross-sectoral way, there are many potential synergies with other EU initiatives (e.g. destinations within Clusters 5 and 6 of the Horizon Europe Work Programme), partnerships (e.g. CETP, ZEWT partnership, Water4All) and, most notably, the Mission Ocean and Waters. Despite the required substantially large transaction costs that are currently not budgeted for in the SBEP, creating a framework for interactions and coordinated exploitation of research results between the SBEP and related activities/partnerships would be very beneficial instead of a plethora of individual activities that could unfold. The creation of new forms of engagement with related initiatives, such as the just-announced enhanced cooperation between SBEP and the Waterborne Transport Partnership or the planned 'portfolio of projects', is a positive step in creating synergies between different EU instruments.

5. Annexes

5.1. Supplementary evidence: Background to the initiative

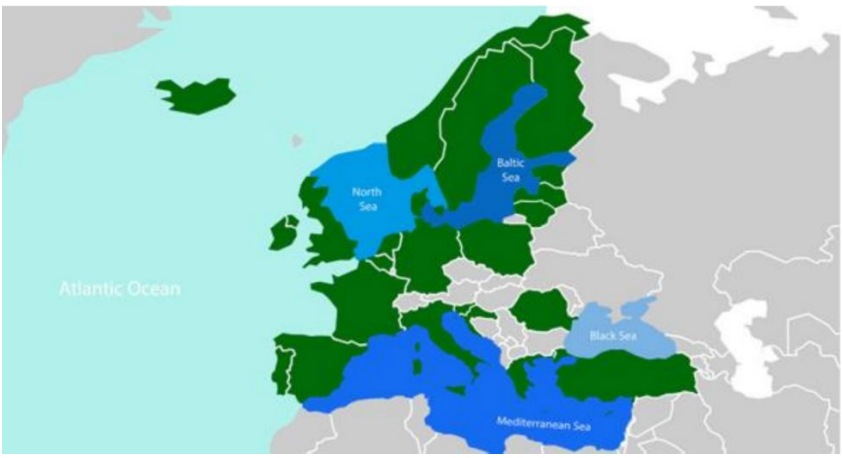

Figure Annex 1: Visualising the SBEP's focus on the bodies of water around Europe. Source: SBEP

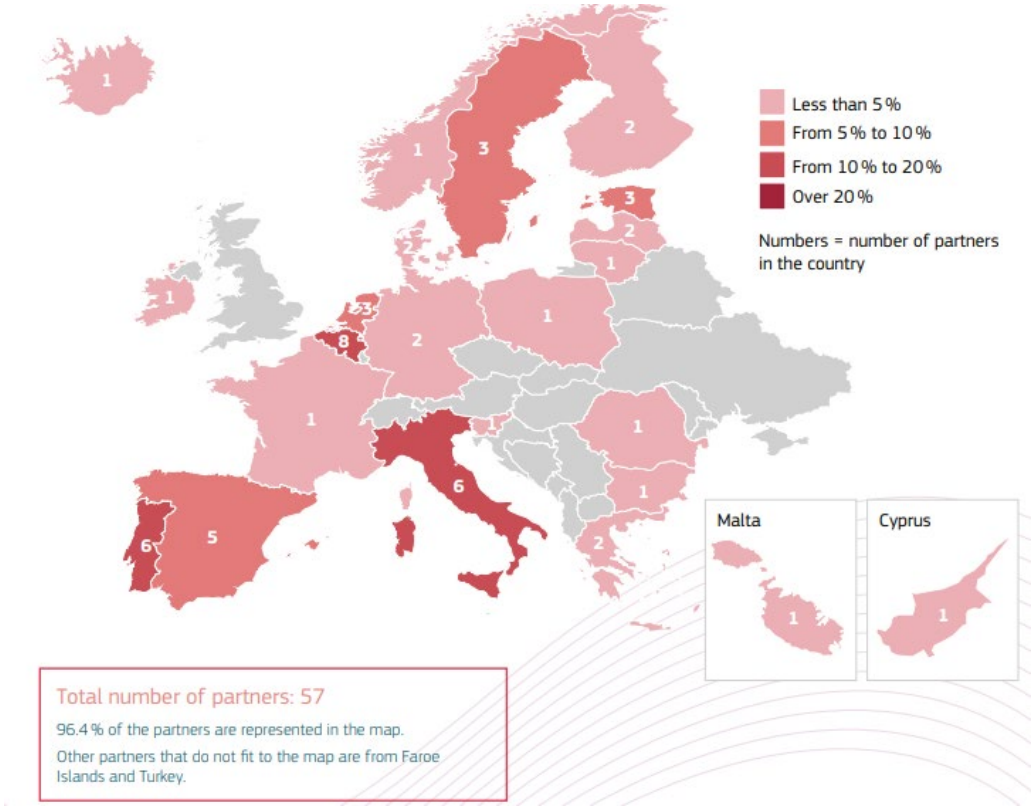

Figure Annex 2: Geographical coverage of partners in SBEP across Europe. Source: BMR2022

Figure Annex 3: Members of SBEP per type. Source: BMR2022

Figure Annex 4: Sea-basin nodes of SBEP. Source: SBEP 2023

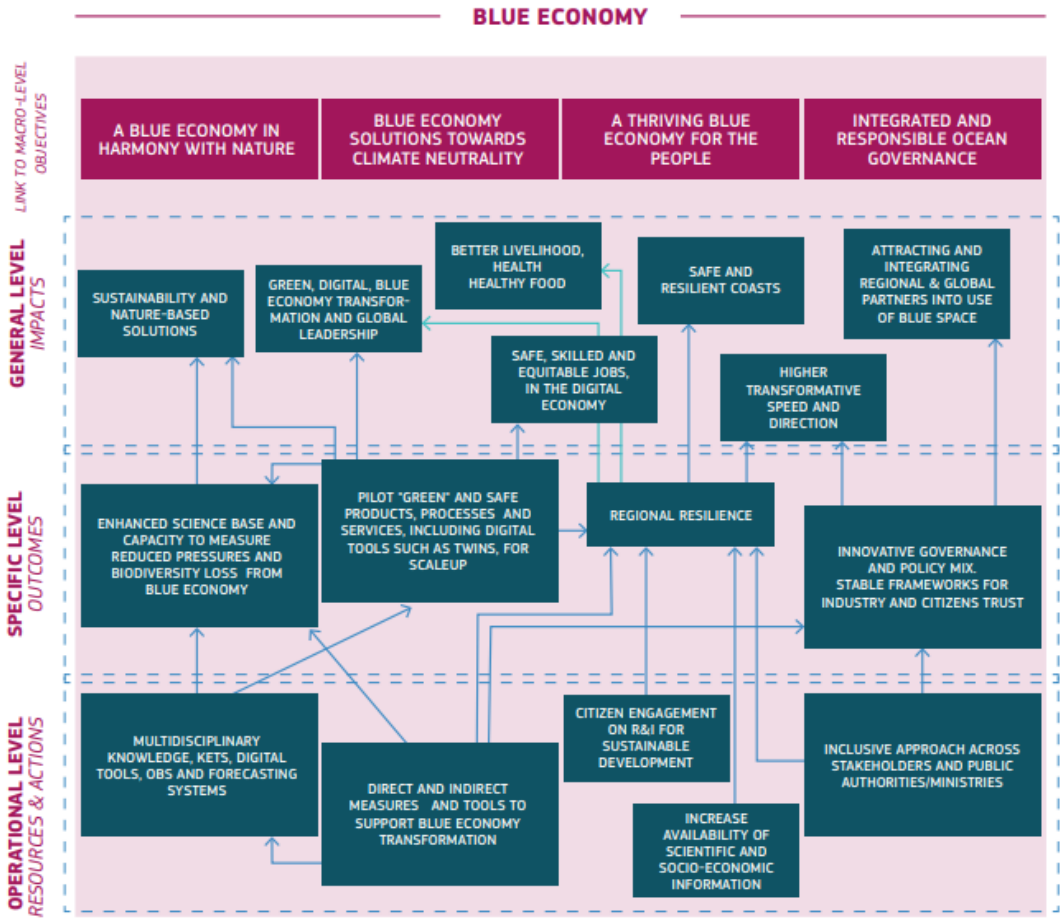

Figure Annex 5: The SBEP's pathways to impact Source: BMR2022

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This evaluation report is part of the interim evaluation of Horizon Europe activities related to the Green Transition. It presents the assessment of the Co-Funded Sustainable Blue Economy Partnership (SBEP) against the evaluation criteria of relevance, coherence, efficiency, effectiveness, EU added value, additionality, directionality, international positioning and visibility, transparency and openness as well as phasing out preparedness. The evaluation of the Partnership is based upon a mixed-method approach including quantitative and qualitative data analysis.

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